PARISH of Aghagallon & Ballinderry

Annual Mass for the Dead Thursday 19th November 2026 at 7pm. During the Mass we will pray for loved ones who have died during the past year. Family members will be invited to remember each person in a special way. Refreshments will be available afterwards in the Community Centre. If you wish to include someone who died outside the parish this year, please leave their details with us before Sunday 8th November.

There will be no morning Mass or Liturgy on Thursday 19th November 2026.

Growing In Faith Together Programme We will welcome the Year 8's who have completed GIFT 1 to our 11am Mass on Sunday 11th October 2026. Last week they had great fun exploring their gifts and talents. To complete GIFT 1 we will be having a celebration night bowling.

G.I.F.T 2 for Year 9's will begin on Monday 9th November 2026 in Aghagallon Community Centre from 7.30-9pm.

Adoration We are blessed to Have Eucharistic Adoration in our Parish Every Wednesday from 10:30am (after Mass) till 10pm. We wish to thank all our current adorers for keeping their commitment to Jesus. We would like this devotion to continue to thrive in our community, but we can't do it without you, our parishioners; the heart and soul of our Parish! We are calling for new adorers to commit to 1hour or 30 minutes of their time every week to spend in the presence of Jesus. **We currently require cover between 6pm-7pm & 8pm-9pm.** There is a sign in sheet in the porch for you to register your time.

Altar Servers We would like to welcome new members to our Altar Servers Club on Saturday 24th October 2026. This is for new and existing members. We will meet in the sacristy of the church at 4pm-7pm Mass, parents are welcome to attend 7pm Mass during which the new altar servers will be commissioned.

WEEKLY BULLETIN
Sunday 11th October 2026

Weekly Collection
£1,331.00
Online
£695.46
Total: £2,024.46

Monthly Stipend
£1,940.00

Thank you for your continued support

Weekly Mass Schedule
12th Oct – 20th Oct 2026

Mass
Monday: 10.00am
Tuesday: 7.00pm
Wednesday: 10.00am
Thursday: 10.00am
Saturday: 7.00pm
(Vigil)
Sunday: 9am & 11am

Liturgy of the Word
Friday: 10am

Adoration
Wednesday 10am-10pm

Confessions
Saturday before Mass

MINISTRY OF WELCOME

We welcome Baby Sénan into our Parish Family, who was baptised recently.

Booking Masses, Baptisms and Weddings As parish office opening hours have been reduced slightly, we are returning to our previous practice of booking Masses, baptisms and weddings in person, in the sacristy after Masses.

Masses can be booked well in advance to ensure your preferred dates are available.

Baptisms can only be booked by the child's parent or legal guardian. At least one month's notice is required. To book a baptism parents must present the child's long birth certificate, complete the baptism request form, meet with one of our Baptism team and attend weekly Mass during the month prior to the date of the Baptism

Weddings can be booked by the couple themselves. Couples are required to give at least six months' notice of marriage to ensure the preferred date is available and that there is adequate time to complete all Civil and Church paperwork.

RECENTLY DECEASED

Ann Shepherd
Joe Mallon
Catherine McCann
Kathleen Ward
Mary Katrina McGrattan

ANNIVERSARIES AT THIS TIME

Philomena MacMorrow	Anniversary Mass Sat 10th Oct at 7pm
Peter Deam	Anniversary Mass Sun 11th Oct at 9am
Lawrence Smyth	Anniversary Mass Sun 11th Oct at 11am
John McCavigan	Anniversary Mass Sat 17th Oct at 7pm
Hugh Shanks	Anniversary Mass Sun 18th Oct at 11am
Lily Lavery	
Bella Lavery	
Mark Toland	
Rosemary Mulholland (1)	
Martha Cushley	Sean Skelton
Bill Mulholland	Gerry McHenry
Arthur Mulholland	Annie McCorry

October Rosary During the month of October we will pray the rosary before all weekday Masses. Thank you to the volunteers who will lead us in prayer.

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Recent Expenditure
Church Heating Oil £548.00

Parish Priest: Fr Declan Mulligan
02892651214
Parish Office Mobile:
Catherine 07485605252

EMERGENCIES AND SICK CALLS
07831 934 756
(in the event you are unable to reach Fr Declan on the emergency number)
02894 422278

St Vincent De Paul
Contact Number:
07598 076585
www.svp.ie

Lifeline Freephone 0808 808 8000
The Knights of St Columbanus
028 92 528 916
Diocesan Safeguarding Office
028 9049 2798

Parish Office Tel: 02892 651214
Email: parishofaandb@yahoo.co.uk
Parish Office Open Tue, Wed & Fri 11am-3pm
All insertions for the bulletin – please leave in the Parochial house red post box, email or phone the parish office before 4pm on Tuesday.

The Parish of Ballyclare & Ballygowan

Notice Board

The Parish of Ballyclare & Ballygowan

11 October 2026

(028) 9334 2226 ballyclare@downandconnor.org

@ballyclareballygowanparish

The Faithful Departed

Anniversaries: Joe Wilson, Drew Carmichael, Susan Hogan, Gerard Crossey, Thomas Agnew, Samuel Haveron, Leanne Small, Rosetta White, Daniel McKenna, Maggie Magill, Patrick McCaughey, Jim McCaughey, Nat Taylor

Eternal Rest Grant unto them, O Lord, and let perpetual light shine upon them.

Masses this week: Monday, Tuesday & Thursday 9.00am

Offerings: Thank you for your recent offerings.
4 October - Weekly Offering £545.20 Monthly Offering £218.00

The Parish SVP will be hosting a Halloween Family fun day – ***Save the Date*** – Saturday, 24th October at 2.00pm – Fancy Dress!

Next Sunday, 18th October, is world Mission Sunday: it is a worldwide day of prayer and support for missionaries working throughout the world. The annual Mission Sunday collection will be taken up at all Masses. If you don't use parish envelopes, you can collect a special envelope for this collection from the Church porch on your way out.

Our Lady's Rosary Festival 12th to 18th October 2026. Join us for a week of events to honour Our Blessed Lady, ending with the annual Belfast Rosary Procession. The procession will leave St Malachy's Church, Belfast City Centre, at 2.30pm on Sunday, 18th October, and finish at St Peter's Cathedral. A full list of events can be found on the poster at the back of the Church and online at belfastrosaryfestival.com

Pilgrimage to Knock for All Souls: leaves St Agnes' Parish, Belfast, Monday 2 November - 7.30am. Cost £30. Contact Pat 07946917354 or Harriet 07812098991



Sacramental Preparation 2026 - 2027

Parents of children who are due to make their **First Confession** & **First Holy Communion** or **Confirmation** are invited to register them now for the parish programme. For First Confession & Communion, children should be in P4 or above, for Confirmation, P7 or above. Full details of the programme and dates will be confirmed in due course.

To register please go to:
https://forms.office.com/e/jVeMBwHX5s
or scan the QR code and complete the online form
Please register by Friday 23rd October

Antrim Parish: are seeking to recruit new sacristans for both St Comgall's & St Joseph's Churches

Antrim Parish. are seeking to recruit new sacristans for both St Comgall's & St Joseph's Churches. Details on the jobs section of the Diocesan website or from Antrim Parish Office.

Blessed Trinity College, Belfast would like to invite all knitters, crocheters and crafters to help our pumpkin appeal and donate handmade pumpkins for our craft pumpkin patch. We are also inviting all parishioners to come along to our craft event on Monday 19th October 3pm-4pm. There will be a range of knitted and crocheted pumpkins to buy and pumpkin art prints and paintings. All proceeds will go to Marys Meals. Crafted pumpkins will be sold for £5 each. Each £5 will feed 50 hungry children in developing countries. Please contact our school office if you would like any more information 02890 370665.

This Week's Hymns			
Entrance	99	Communion	514
Offertory	540	Recessional	50

DONATE

Please click on the button if you wish to make an online donatation to the Parish of Ballyclare and Ballygowan. Thank you.

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Mass Timings for the weekdays and weekends
(17th August onwards)

Mass Times

Monday - 7pm St Nicholas
Tuesday - 10am St Nicholas
Thursday - 7pm Our Lady of Lourdes
Friday - 10am Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 9.30 Our Lady of Lourdes
- 11.30 St Nicholas

Confessions

Monday - 6.15 to 6.50 - St Nicholas
Thursday - 6.15 to 6.50 - Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 9am to 9.20am - Our Lady of Lourdes
Sunday - 11am to 11.20am - St Nicholas

MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

St Bernadette's Parish
Vigil 6.00pm & 11am
Holy Rosary Parish
9am, 10.30am & 12.30pm

WEEKDAYS
St Bernadette's Parish:
Mon, Tues & Wed 9.30am
Holy Rosary Parish:
Thurs, Fri & Sat 10.00am

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION
Good Shepherd church Saturday **10.30am**
St. Bernadette's church Saturday **5.15pm**

BAPTISMS
(Prior booking via Parish Office)
Holy Rosary Church: Third Sunday of the month at 2p.m.
St Bernadette's Church: First Saturday of the month at 2p.m.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Fr. Brendan Hickland, PP (028) 90642446 (Option 1)
b.hickland@downandconnor.org

Fr. Babu Panattuparambil Vareed Assistant Priest
(028) 9079 3023.
Rev. Patrick Keown (Deacon) p.keown@downandconnor.org

Kylee (Parish Support Officer) Office Hours
Mon-Thurs 9.15a.m - 1p.m. Closed Fridays

Holy Rosary Parish Office (028) 90642446 Option 2
holyrosary@downandconnor.org

Philomena (Finance Officer) p.dawson@downandconnor.org
More Information and resources:
holyrosaryparishbelfast.net and www.st.bernadettesparish.org

COME AND SING WITH US!

St. Bernadette's Parish Choir is looking for new members! We return to our musical duties on **Sunday 6th September**, singing each week at the **11.00am Sunday Mass**, with a rehearsal beforehand.
There are no auditions, and you don't need to be an experienced singer - just someone who enjoys singing and would like to be part of our choir. We warmly welcome singers of all ages, so if you've ever thought about joining us, now is the perfect time to give it a try!
For more information, speak to Marty Lavery,
our organist and choir director, or to any member of the choir.

Down and Connor Cantor Training

Adults (18+) involved in parish music are invited to take part in Cantor Training at St Joseph's Parish Centre, Dunloy. Training takes place on Saturday 3 October, 17 October and 7 November, from 10.00am to 3.00pm (registration from 9.30am). Attendance at all three days is required for commissioning as a parish cantor. To request an application form, contact your parish office.



TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
SUNDAY
6th September
Readings: A (I) ❖ Psalter: Week 3



? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ?
INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY
ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' Course

When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha. **FOLLOWING CHRIST** is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The course will commence on **TUESDAY 15 SEPTEMBER 2026** at **7:00pm** in **HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.**
Each evening will follow a format similar to the Alpha Course and include a video presentation and small group discussions each evening.
We will also have time for tea and coffee and a little something to eat!
The evening should last no more than a couple of hours.
To register for '**FOLLOWING CHRIST'** course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and preferably your mobile telephone number to
stbrigids@downandconnor.org
A short information video can be found here:
christlife.org/about/christlife-process/following-christ/

St Bernadette's Third World Group - Lima Mission

Father Coney and staff members from St Bernadette's Children's Centres in Lima will be speaking at St Bernadette's Masses **Sat 5th & Sunday 6th September**. Their aim is to thank the Sponsors for their continued support over many years, and at the same time promote the sustainability of the projects. The Third World Group is collecting annual sponsorship payments after both Masses this weekend and also on **12th &13th September**. If you would like to sponsor a child within the Centres please speak to us after Mass. We will be happy to give further details.
Many thanks to all sponsors for your continued support.

FÁILTE - WELCOME GROUP

There will be a get together of the group and new members in the coffee lounge (St Bernadette's parish centre) on the **13th September after 11am mass**. We are blessed to have 16 members and would be delighted if more parishioners came along to join us. You will find it to be a very worthwhile and enriching ministry to be part of. Beannacht Dia libh.

HLI Ireland

Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

THE WEST BELFAST HISTORICAL SOCIETY

The September **Friday the 11th of September at 7.30pm** in St. Michael's Parish Centre**,** The September talk is entitled:
"The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918"
The guest speaker will be Mr Michael McConway

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.
Episode dates: **11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct,**
9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October. Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie 07955 282371

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY COLLECTION: **Holy Rosary: £1997.00**
St. Bernadette's: £1065.52

Many thanks for your continued generosity and support

The Monthly Offering Collection for the support of the priests will be taken up this weekend, after Communion. The Building Fund Collection will be taken up next week, in Holy Rosary. Collection offering can be made by standing order or the Dona machines in the church porch.

St Bernadette's Parish Centre

for all bookings and enquiries please email:
stbernadettes@downandconnor.org

Holy Rosary Senior Citizens

Senior Citizens monthly meet-up returns after summer break on Monday 7th September at 8pm. New members very welcome.

St Bernadette's Retirement Group

St Vincent de Paul have invited us to join them for their trip to Mount Stewart on Thursday 17th September.
If you're interested please phone Frances 07800562398 or leave your name in the sacristy.
Welcome back after our beautiful summer.
We hope to see you at our next coffee morning on Wednesday 23rd September after Mass.
New members are welcome. £5 registration.
Our Thursday weekly walk: we meet at 10:15 in the church carpark.
All members are welcome to join in at any time.

B.I.N.G.O is back, we're hoping for a FULL HOUSE!

18th October & 15th November



REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased:

Georgia Ann Nugent
Joesph Rollins
Michael McKinney
Philip Smith
Edward (Teddy) Dickson
Thomas (Tommy) Napier
Patrick (Pat) McCarney
Frank Maguire
Gerald (Gerry) Henvey

Anniversaries:

Raymond Glover (6pm)
Laura Heaney (9am)
Denis Carey (10.30am)
Eileen Higgins & Paul Cavana (12.30pm)
David Carville, Joesph Woods,
Francis McGinty

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

Parish of Blaris

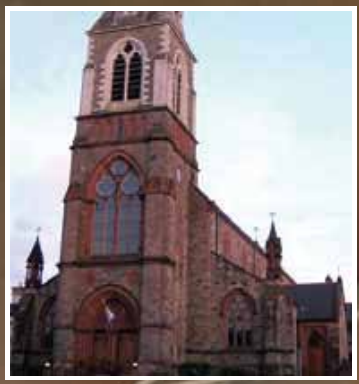
Sunday11th October 2026
The Twenty Eighth Sunday in Ordinary Time

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH
Masses Monday – Friday 10.00am
Saturday Vigil: 6.30pm
Sunday: 10.00am & 12 noon

LIVE WEBSTREAMING OF ALL MASSES

Please note many parishes in the Diocese have webcams installed which provide live coverage of various Masses taking place daily throughout the Diocese. These can be accessed by visiting www.downandconnor.org Links to Parish Webcams. Live Church webcam links: CHURCH SERVICES. TV & MCN MEDIA CHURCH WEBCAMS

Many are called, but few are chosen.
Matthew 22:14






Fr. Dermot McCaughan, PP: 028 9266 2341
Fr. Eamon Magorrian, CC: 028 9266 2348

Parish Office Opening Hours:
Monday-Friday 10.30am-4.00pm.
Closed 1.00pm-2.00pm.

Parish Office: 028 9266 0206 Fax: 028 9266 5690
Email: lisburn@downandconnor.org
Pastoral Centre: 028 9260 7110
www.parishoflisburn.org

INTRODUCTORY RITES

Congregation stands

Entrance Hymn or
Entrance Antiphon **Ps. 129:3-4**

All: **If you, O Lord, should mark iniquities,**
Lord, who could stand?
But with you is found forgiveness,
O God of Israel.

GREETING

Priest: In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.
All: **Amen**
Priest: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ,
and the love of God,
and the communion of the Holy Spirit
be with you all.
All: **And with your spirit.**

PENITENTIAL ACT

Priest: Brothers and sisters, let us acknowledge our sins, and so prepare ourselves to celebrate the sacred mysteries.

Priest: Lord Jesus, you came to reconcile us to one another and to the Father:
Lord, have mercy. **Lord, have mercy.**

Priest: Lord Jesus, you heal the wounds of sin and division:
Christ, have mercy. **Christ, have mercy.**

Priest: Lord Jesus, you intercede for us with your Father:
Lord, have mercy. **Lord, have mercy.**

Priest: May almighty God have mercy on us,
forgive us our sins,
and bring us to everlasting life.
All: **Amen**

GLORIA

All: **Glory to God in the highest,**
and on earth peace to people of good will.

We praise you, we bless you,
we adore you, we glorify you,
we give you thanks for your great glory,
Lord God, heavenly King,
O God, almighty Father.

Lord Jesus Christ, Only Begotten Son,
Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father,
you take away the sins of the world,
have mercy on us;
you take away the sins of the world,
receive our prayer;
you are seated at the right hand of the Father,
have mercy on us.

For you alone are the Holy One, you alone are the Lord, you alone are the Most High,
Jesus Christ, with the Holy Spirit, in the glory of God the Father.
Amen.

THE COLLECT

Priest: Let us pray.

Pause for silent prayer

Priest: May your grace, O Lord, we pray,
at all times go before us and follow after
and make us always determined
to carry out good works.
Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son,
who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit,one God, for ever and ever.
All: **Amen.**

THE LITURGY OF THE WORD

Congregation Sits

FIRST READING

A reading from the prophet Isaiah 25:6-10

On this mountain,
the Lord of hosts will prepare for all people
a banquet of rich food, a banquet of fine wines,
of food rich and juicy, of fine strained wines.
On this mountain he will remove
the mourning veil covering all peoples,
and the shroud enwrapping all nations,
he will destroy Death for ever.
The Lord will wipe away
the tears from every cheek;
he will take away his people's shame
everywhere on earth,
for the Lord has said so.
That day, it will be said: See, this is our God
in whom we hoped for salvation;
the Lord is the one in whom we hoped.
We exult and we rejoice
that he has saved us;
for the hand of the Lord
rests on this mountain.

The word of the Lord
All: **Thanks be to God.**

RESPONSORIAL PSALM Ps 22. R v.6

(R) **In the Lord's own house shall I dwell**
for ever and ever.

1. The Lord is my shepherd;
there is nothing I shall want.
Fresh and green are the pastures
where he gives me repose.
Near restful waters he leads me,
to revive my drooping spirit. **(R)**

2. He guides me along the right path;
he is true to his name.
If I should walk in the valley of darkness
no evil would I fear.
You are there with your crook and your staff;
with these you give me comfort. **(R)**

3. You have prepared a banquet for me
in the sight of my foes.
My head you have anointed with oil;
my cup is overflowing. **(R)**

4. Surely goodness and kindness shall follow me
all the days of my life.
In the Lord's own house shall I dwell
for ever and ever. **(R)**

SECOND READING

A reading from the letter of St Paul to the Philippians 4:12-14. 19-20

I know how to be poor and I know how to be rich too. I have been through my initiation and now I am ready for anything anywhere: full stomach or empty stomach, poverty or plenty. There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength. All the same, it was good of you to share with me in my hardships. In return my God will fulfil all your needs, in Christ Jesus, as lavishly as only God can. Glory to God, our Father, for ever and ever. Amen.

The word of the Lord.
All: **Thanks be to God.**

Congregation stands

ACCLAMATION **Jn 1:12. 14**

All: **Alleluia, alleluia!**
The Word was made flesh and lived among us;
to all who did accept him
he gave power to become children of God.
Alleluia!

GOSPEL

Priest: The Lord be with you.
All: **And with your spirit.**
Priest: A reading from the holy Gospel according to Matthew 22:1-14
All: **Glory to you, O Lord.**

Jesus said to the chief priests and elders of the people: 'The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who gave a feast for his son's wedding. He sent his servants to call those who had been invited, but they would not come. Next he sent some more servants. "Tell those who have been invited" he said "that I have my banquet all prepared, my oxen and fattened cattle have been slaughtered, everything is ready. Come to the wedding." But they were not interested: one went off to his farm, another to his business, and the rest seized his servants, maltreated them and killed them. The king was furious. He dispatched his troops, destroyed those murderers and burnt their town. Then he said to his servants, "The wedding is ready; but as those who were invited proved to be unworthy, go to the crossroads in the town and invite everyone you can find to the wedding." So these servants went out on to the roads and collected together everyone they could find, bad and good alike; and the wedding hall was filled with guests.

When the king came in to look at the guests he noticed one man who was not wearing a wedding garment, and said to him, "How did you get in here, my friend, without a wedding garment?" And the man was silent. Then the king said to the attendants, "Bind him hand and foot and throw him out into the dark, where there will be weeping and grinding of teeth." For many are called, but few are chosen.'

The Gospel of the Lord.
All: **Praise to you Lord Jesus Christ.**

Congregation sits

HOMILY

Congregation stand

THE CREED

All: **I believe in one God,**
the Father almighty,
maker of heaven and earth,
of all things visible and invisible.

I believe in one Lord Jesus Christ,
the Only Begotten Son of God,
born of the Father before all ages.
God from God, Light from Light,
true God from true God,
begotten, not made, consubstantial with the Father; through him all things were made
For us and for our salvation
he came down from heaven,

(bow your head up to the words 'and became man')

and by the Holy Spirit was incarnate of the Virgin Mary, and became man.

For our sake he was crucified under Pontius Pilate, he suffered death and was buried,
and rose again on the third day
in accordance with the Scriptures.
He ascended into heaven
and is seated at the right hand of the Father.

He will come again in glory
to judge the living and the dead
and his kingdom will have no end.

I believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the giver of life, who proceeds from the Father and the Son, who with the Father and the Son is adored and glorified, who has spoken through the prophets.

I believe in one, holy, catholic and apostolic Church. I confess one Baptism for the forgiveness of sins and I look forward to the resurrection of the dead and the life of the world to come. Amen.

PRAYER OF THE FAITHFUL

Congregation sits

THE LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

Offertory Procession

The gifts of bread and wine which will become the Lord's body and blood are brought to the altar.
The celebrant raises the host on the paten saying:

Priest: Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received
the bread we offer you:
fruit of the earth and work of human hands,
it will become for us the bread of life.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

The celebrant pours wine and a little water into the chalice, saying quietly:

Priest: By the mystery of this water and wine
may we come to share in the divinity of Christ
who humbled himself to share in our humanity.

The celebrant then raises the chalice above the altar and says:

Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received

the wine we offer you:
fruit of the vine and work of human hands,
it will become our spiritual drink.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

Bowing, the celebrant says quietly:

Priest: With humble spirit and contrite heart
may we be accepted by you, O Lord,
and may our sacrifice in your sight this day
be pleasing to you, Lord God.

Then the celebrant washes his hands, saying quietly:

Wash me, O Lord, from my iniquity
and cleanse me from my sin.

Pray, brothers and sisters, that my sacrifice and
yours may be acceptable to God,
the almighty Father.

All: **May the Lord accept the sacrifice at your hands for the praise and glory of his name, for our good and the good of all his holy Church.**

PRAYER OVER THE OFFERINGS

Priest: Accept, O Lord, the prayers of your faithful
with these sacrificial offerings,
that, through these acts of devotedness,
we may pass over to the glory of heaven.
Through Christ our Lord.
All: **Amen**

Congregation stands

EUCHARISTIC PRAYER II

Priest: The Lord be with you.
All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: Lift up your hearts.
All: **We lift them up to the Lord.**

Priest: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.
All: **It is right and just.**

PREFACE (III in Ordinary Time)

Priest: It is truly right and just, our duty and our salvation,
always and everywhere to give you thanks,
Lord, holy Father, almighty and eternal God.

For we know it belongs to your boundless glory,
that you came to the aid of mortal beings with
your divinity and even fashioned for us a remedy
out of mortality itself, that the cause of our
downfall might become the means of our
salvation, through Christ our Lord.

Through him the host of Angels adores your
majesty and rejoices in your presence for ever.
May our voices, we pray, join with theirs
in one chorus of exultant praise, as we acclaim:

ACCLAMATION

All: **Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of hosts.**
Heaven and earth are full of your glory.
Hosanna in the highest.
Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.
Hosanna in the highest.

Priest: You are indeed Holy, O Lord,
the fount of all holiness.

Make holy, therefore, these gifts, we pray,
by sending down your Spirit upon them like the
dewfall, so that they may become for us
the Body and + Blood of our Lord Jesus Christ.

At the time he was betrayed
and entered willingly into his Passion,
he took bread and, giving thanks, broke it,
and gave it to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND EAT OF IT,
FOR THIS IS MY BODY
WHICH WILL BE GIVEN UP FOR YOU.

In a similar way, when supper was ended,
he took the chalice and,
once more giving thanks,
he gave it to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND DRINK FROM IT,
FOR THIS IS THE CHALICE OF MY BLOOD,
THE BLOOD OF THE NEW AND ETERNAL
COVENANT, WHICH WILL BE POURED OUT FOR
YOU AND FOR MANY FOR THE FORGIVENESS
OF SINS.

DO THIS IN MEMORY OF ME.

Priest: The mystery of faith.

All: **My Lord and my God.**

Priest: Therefore, as we celebrate
the memorial of his Death and Resurrection,
we offer you, Lord,
the Bread of life and the Chalice of salvation,
giving thanks that you have held us worthy
to be in your presence and minister to you.

Humbly we pray
that, partaking of the Body and Blood of Christ,
we may be gathered into one by the Holy Spirit.

Remember, Lord, your Church,
spread throughout the world,
and bring her to the fullness of charity,
together with Leo our Pope and N. our Bishop
and all the clergy.

Remember also our brothers and sisters
who have fallen asleep in the hope of the
resurrection, and all who have died in your mercy:
welcome them into the light of your face.
Have mercy on us all, we pray,
that with the Blessed Virgin Mary, Mother of God,
with blessed Joseph, her spouse,
with the blessed Apostles,
and all the Saints who have pleased you
throughout the ages,
we may merit to be coheirs to eternal life,
and may praise and glorify you
through your Son, Jesus Christ.

Priest: Through him, and with him, and in him,
O God, almighty Father,

in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
all glory and honour is yours,
for ever and ever.
All: **Amen.**

Congregation stands

THE COMMUNION RITE

Priest: At the Saviour's command
and formed by divine teaching,
we dare to say:

All: **Our Father, who art in heaven,**
hallowed be thy name;
thy kingdom come,
thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those who trespass against us;
and lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.

Priest: Deliver us, Lord, we pray, from every evil,
graciously grant peace in our days,
that, by the help of your mercy,
we may be always free from sin
and safe from all distress,
as we await the blessed hope
and the coming of our Saviour, Jesus Christ.

All: **For the kingdom, the power and the glory**
are yours now and for ever.

Priest: Lord Jesus Christ, who said to your Apostles:
Peace I leave you, my peace I give you,
look not on our sins, but on the faith of your Church,
and graciously grant her peace and unity
in accordance with your will.
Who live and reign for ever and ever.
All: **Amen**.

Priest: The peace of the Lord be with you always.
All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May this mingling of the Body and Blood of our Lord
Jesus Christ bring eternal life to us who receive it.

All: **Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the**
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, grant us peace.

Congregation kneels
The celebrant says quietly:
May the receiving of your Body and Blood,
Lord Jesus Christ,
not bring me to judgment and condemnation,
but through your loving mercy
be for me protection in mind and body
and a healing remedy.

INVITATION TO HOLY COMMUNION

Priest: Behold the Lamb of God,
behold him who takes away the sins of the world.
Blessed are those called to the supper of the Lamb.

All: **Lord, I am not worthy**
that you should enter under my roof,
but only say the word
and my soul shall be healed.

Priest: May the Body of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

Priest: May the Blood of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

COMMUNION ANTIPHON Cf. Ps 33:11

All: **The rich suffer want and go hungry,**
but those who seek the Lord lack no blessing.

Purifying the chalice the celebrant says quietly:
What has passed our lips as food, O Lord,
may we possess in purity of heart,
that what has been given to us in time
may be our healing for eternity.

PRAYER AFTER COMMUNION

Congregation kneels

Priest: Let us pray.
We entreat your majesty most humbly, O Lord,
that, as you feed us with the nourishment
which comes from the most holy Body and Blood
of your Son, so you may make us sharers of his
divine nature.
Who lives and reigns for ever and ever.
All: **Amen**

THE CONCLUDING RITES

Priest: The Lord be with you.
All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May the peace of God,
which surpasses all understanding,
keep your hearts and minds
in the knowledge and love of God,
and of his Son, our Lord Jesus Christ.
All: **Amen**

Priest: And may the blessing of almighty God,
the Father, and the Son, + and the Holy Spirit,
come down on you and remain with you for ever.
All: **Amen**

Then the celebrant, with hands joined and facing the people, says:

Priest: Go forth, the Mass is ended.
All: **Thanks be to God.**

Imprimatur – nihil obstat: + Most Rev. Alan McGuckian, SJ, Bishop of Down and Connor. Excerpts from the English translation of The Roman Missal © 2010, International Committee on English in the Liturgy Corporation. All rights reserved. Jerusalem Bible version of the scriptures copyright: Darton, Longman & Todd Ltd and Doubleday & Co. Inc. Responsorial Psalms are copyright The Grail and/or Geoffrey Chapman Ltd. Created and published by Tara Lees, 1 Lille Park, Belfast, BT10 0LR. T: 02890302817. E: tarabooklet@gmail.com.



We pray for our beloved dead:
RECENTLY DECEASED: Katrina Hunter: Pat Toal: Michael Lombard
MONTH'S MIND: John McDonald
ANNIVERSARIES: Owen Comiskey: Martin Gilroy: Francis & Eliza O'Brien: Peter Ewing: Lily Turley: Edward Nelson: Gerard McKeown: Rose Langan: Edith & Frank Cairns: Joe & Mary Roy: Nancy Crockard: Betty Mulholland: Margaret Hughes: Margaret Rogers:John Phillips: Bob Connaghan.

THIS WEEK'S CALENDAR

Wednesday 15 October: St Teresa of Avila, Virgin and Doctor of the Church
Saturday 17 October: St Ignatius of Antioch, Bishop and Martyr

INDIAN CATHOLIC COMMUNITY

Mass will be celebrated in Syro-Malabar Rite in St. Patrick's Church on Sunday 18th October at 3pm.
10 DAY ROSARY RECITATION commences Friday October 16th at 6pm in Church
Continues Saturday October 17th at 4pm
Sunday 18th October at 2pm
Monday 19th, Tuesday 20th, Wednesday 21st, Thursday 22nd and Friday 23rd October at 6pm
Concludes Saturday 24th October at 4pm

OUR LADY OF CONSOLATION BEREAVEMENT MINISTRY

Meeting of Bereavement Ministers in Parochial House on Monday 26th October at 7.00pm

SPECIAL REMEMBRANCE MASS

The Annual Mass for our beloved dead will be held in St. Patrick's Church at 7.30pm on Friday 6th November. At the Liturgy we will remember all our dead and bereaved parishioners with a special emphasis on those who have lost loved ones within the past year. Named candles will be available for relatives of those who have died within the past year in our parish.
If you have lost a loved one who has been laid to rest **OUTSIDE OF THE PARISH WITHIN THE PAST YEAR** and wish to light a candle in their memory at the Remembrance Mass please contact Maria in the Parish Office.
Tel: 028 92 660206. Email: lisburn@downandconnor.org

NOVEMBER – THE MONTH OF THE HOLY SOULS

The November Dead Lists (envelopes provided) are available in church porches.
Returned lists and donations should be placed in envelope and returned to the safe in right hand side alcove of the church, beside confession box. All Masses will be celebrated during the month of November for all names included on lists. Since all believers are bound together by the love of Christ, the dead are not beyond our love. We are linked to the dead, just as when they were alive; and so our motivation to pray for them is love. We include in our prayers those forgotten who have no one to pray for them.
PLEASE RETURN ALL LISTS BEFORE THE BEGINNING OF NOVEMBER. THANK YOU.

OUR LADY'S ROSARY FESTIVAL will take place from 12th to 18th October 2026. Join us for a week of events to honour Our Blessed Lady, ending with the annual Belfast Rosary Procession. The procession will leave St Malachy's Church, Belfast City Centre, at 2.30pm on Sunday 18th October, and finish at St Peter's Cathedral.
A full list of events can be found on the poster at the back of the Church and online at belfastrosaryfestival.com

QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY is delighted to welcome **Dr Paul Shrimpton**, writer, historian and scholar of St John Henry Newman, for a public lecture exploring Newman's vision of **human flourishing at university** — and what it might still have to say to universities and society today.
Monday 12 October, 7.00pm Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy, 30–38 Elmwood Avenue, Belfast
Students, staff, alumni and friends are warmly welcome. Admission free.

ST. JOSEPH'S PRIMARY SCHOOL, LISBURN

Open Evening: 6:30pm on Thursday 26th November 2026
and
Open Morning: 9:30am on Friday 27th November 2026

ST. PATRICK'S GAC

Huge congratulations to our **U16 ladies** who have had a very successful year, winning the league, the Championship and just last weekend the Feile. Well done to all involved, players, coaches and families.
The **ladies' Minor team** have a Championship match today (Sunday 11th October) away to Ballymena with throw in at midday. We wish them luck. There are still places available for the **St Patrick's Golf day at Down Royal on Saturday 24th October**. Contact any Committee member or book online at naomh-padraig.com

BULLETIN NOTICES AND ANNIVERSARIES

Bulletin Notices should be with the Parish Office by 12 noon on Monday to be included in the weekend bulletin.
Please note all emails to Parish Office should be addressed to – lisburn@downandconnor.org

PRISONS WEEK 2026 11–17 OCTOBER, WITH THE THEME "ALL ARE INVITED," INSPIRED BY MATTHEW 22:1–14.
The week begins with Prisoners' Sunday on 11 October and focuses on prayer and action for victims of crime, offenders, families, and all working in the criminal justice system. Prisons week raises awareness and generates prayer. It motivates volunteers to step forward and give their time and gifts, in prisons and in their own communities. It provides an annual focus and reason for Christians to work together, building capacity and motivation to make a difference for people who are out of sight and often out of mind.

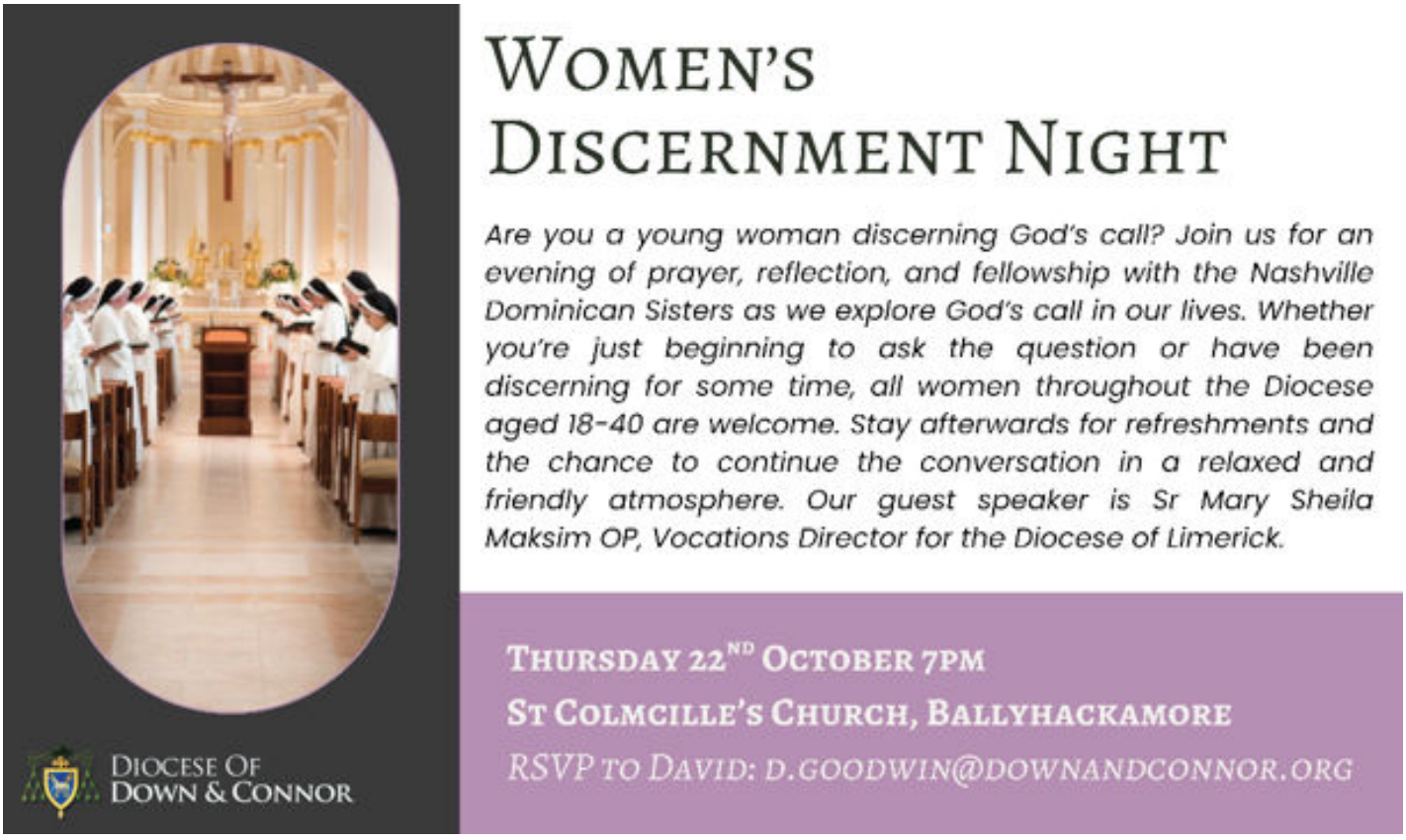
THE PRISONS WEEK PRAYER

Lord, you offer freedom to all people. We pray for those in prison.
Break the bonds of fear and isolation that exist.
Support with your love prisoners and their families and friends, prison staff and all who care.
Heal those who have been wounded by the activities of others, especially the victims of crime.
Help us to forgive one another.
To act justly, love mercy and walk humbly together with Christ
in His strength and in His Spirit, now and every day. Amen.

PATHWAYS TO THE FUTURE are pleased to invite you to a Zoom training evening introducing the **Sycamore Advent programme**. This session will provide an overview of the programme, explain how it can be used in parish communities during Advent, and offer practical guidance and resources to help you lead sessions. There will also be an opportunity to ask questions and share ideas with other parish leaders.
Date: Tuesday 20th October 2026 **Time:** 7pm – 8.30pm **Venue:** Zoom
The training is intended for lay parish leaders and anyone involved in evangelisation, catechesis, small groups or parish formation. No previous experience with Sycamore is required. Please confirm your attendance by completing the booking link by **15th October.** https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/f7S5ycvmn2

RECHARGE YOUNG ADULT GROUP ST COLUMCILLE'S CHURCH, BELFAST
All young adults aged 18-35 are welcome to the following event in St Colmcille's, Belfast:
20th October @ 7.30pm - Group Study

LISBURN CITY LIBRARY will host a **Positive Ageing Fair** on **Tuesday 13 October from 10:00am – 1:00pm** as part of Positive Ageing Month. This free, drop-in event will showcase the wide range of opportunities available in the Lisburn area for older people who want to explore new interests, rediscover old passions or simply meet others in a welcoming space. Visitors can chat with representatives from local organisations covering everything from arts and crafts, history and photography to sport, volunteering, health and lifelong learning.
Groups taking part on the day include the NI Family History Society, Lagan Valley Rural Transport, Earlybirds Choir, South Eastern Trust and Lisburn and Castlereagh City Council's Age Friendly and Be Active Stay Active teams and many more. Everyone is welcome to drop in any time between 10:00am and 1:00pm.



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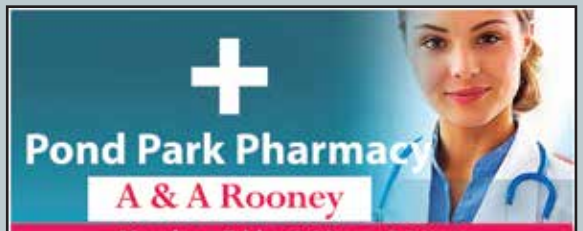
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PARISH of Maghera WEEKLY BULLETIN

SUNDAY 11TH OCTOBER 2026

TWENTY-EIGHTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Prisoner's Sunday

Sunday Cycle A, Psalter Week 4

PARISH of Maghera

✠ MASS TIMES & LITURGIES

OUR LADY OF THE ASSUMPTION CHURCH NEWCASTLE

WEEKDAY MASSES:
Mon, Tues, Thurs, Fri at 10am

LITURGY OF THE WORD & HOLY COMMUNION: Wed & Sat 10am

WEEKEND MASSES:
Saturday Vigil Mass at 6pm & Sunday Mass at 11.30am

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH BRYANSFORD: Open for Private Prayer Only. Open daily from 10am To 5pm

EUCHARISTIC ADORATION:
Fridays, 10.30am–5.00pm

CONFESSIONS
1st & 3rd Saturday, 3.30–4.00pm

BAPTISMS: 1st & 3rd Sat, 3–3.30pm. Book in sacristy after Mass. Bring long birth certificate

WEDDINGS: Arrange with Fr Jim after Mass. Weddings can also be arranged in St Patrick's, Bryansford.

The Parish of Maghera is a part of the **Diocese of Down and Connor Trust** and operates in accordance with the Diocesan policies. Registered UK Charity No. **XN46141** Charity Name: **Down and Connor Diocesan Trust**

✠ FAMILY OF PARISHES

Parish of Dundrum & Tyrella
Mon–Thurs 9.30am; Sat 10am (Dundrum);
Fri 9.30am (Ballykinlar);
Saturday Vigil 6pm (Ballykinlar);
Sunday Mass 11am (Dundrum)

Parish of Kilmegan & Kilcoo
St. Malachy's Church, Castlewellan
Mon, Tues, Thurs , Fri 9.30am
Saturday Vigil 5pm
Sunday 10am
(Kilcoo): Sat Vigil 5pm & Sun Mass 10:00am (Kilcoo):
Mon 9.30am; Wed–Fri 9.30am
Tues 9:30am (Aughlisnafin)

✠ CONTACT DETAILS

PARISH PRIEST: FR JIM CRUDDEN
Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 028 437 22401

PARISH MANAGER: BRENDA WEBB
Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 07840 028461
emails: b.webb@downandconnor.org / brenda@parishofmaghera.com

PARISH SUPPORT OFFICER: VIRGINIA HUGHES
Parish Office, Parochial House, 24 Downs Road, Newcastle, BT33 0AG. Tel: 028 437 22401
Office Hours: Tue–Fri 10am–1pm (Closed Monday). Emails: Newcastle@downandconnor.org / parishoffice@parishofmaghera.com
Web: www.parishofmaghera.com
FB: Parish of Maghera D&C
To access the Parish webcam: https://www.mcn.live/camera/our-lady-of-the-assumption-church-newcastle

SACRISTANS: STEPHEN BODEN / ANTHONY CREELMAN
Tel: 028 4372 7691 (after Mass)

PARISH SHOP: EUGENE SMALL
14 Main Street – 028 4372 3399
Opening Time: Mon, Tue, Thu, Fri, Sat – 10.30m-4.30pm (Closed Wednesday)

ROOM/HALL HIRE: PARISH CENTRE & ST PATRICK'S HALL: EAMON LENEGHAN / JOE DUGGAN – Office at 14 Main Street Tel: 028 4372 3399. Office Hours Mon, Wed & Fri 9.30am–1.30pm
Email: newcastlebookings@downandconnor.org

SAFEGUARDING. If you have a concern, suspicion or wish to report an allegation of abuse, please contact: Philip O'Hara, Diocesan Designated Liaison Person, 120 Cliftonville Rd, Belfast BT14 6LA Tel: 07534991124 E: philip.ohara@soddc.org

IF YOU ARE IN NEED OF HELP
Please Contact the St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07889780330 or Lifeline on: 0808 808 8000

✠ MINISTRY OF WELCOME

RECENTLY BAPTISED
Thomas John / James / Rian Michael / Killian / Shakti Grace

BEREAVEMENT MINISTRY
Please remember in your prayers:
RECENTLY DECEASED: Fr Aidan O'Kane (Tobar Mhuire) / Patricia Archer (Belfast)
MONTH'S MIND: Edith O'Hare / Jean Paul / Pat McClean / Lelija Tamoseviciene
ANNIVERSARY: James Somerville

✠ MASS INTENTIONS

SAT, 10TH – 18TH OCT 2026
Sat, 10th 6pm Rosena Small / The Crawford Family / Cecil Truesdale / Barney McCaffrey / Rosaleen Harbinson
Sun, 11th 11.30am Harry Mathers / Michael Cunningham / Colm Cunningham / Edith O'Hare
Fri, 16th 10am Danny Mageean
Sat, 17th 10am Jean Paul / Tracy Hewitt / Maria Rodgers / Pat McCartan
Sun, 18th 11.30 Pat McClean / Lelija Tamoseviciene
"May their souls and the souls of all the faithful departed rest in peace."

✠ SANCTUARY CANDLES

This week's Sanctuary Candles will burn for: **Special Intentions**

✠ OFFERTORY COLLECTIONS

£2454.44, Standing Order: £641.33, Total: £3095.77.
Diocesan Priests Welfare: £1570.66 Standing Order: £105.50, Total: £1676.16.

The Flame of Love of the Immaculate Heart of Mary. Flame of Love Cenacle takes place every Friday after 10am Mass at the side chapel. All welcome!

Pope Leo's prayer intention. October 2026: Mental Health Ministry - Let us pray that the mental health ministry be established throughout the Church, helping to overcome the stigma and discrimination of persons with mental illnesses.

DONATE TO THE PARISH

PRAYER PETITION

SCAN QR CODES WITH YOUR PHONE CAMERA TO:

PARISH CENTRE / HALL

PARISH FORMS

PARISH OF NEWTOWNARDS & COMBER

TWENTY-EIGHTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME YEAR A

11TH OCTOBER 2026 DIVINE OFFICE PSALTER: WEEK 4

PARISH PRIEST

Very Rev. Brian McCann PP
Tel: 028 91812137

PERMANENT DEACON
Rev. Derek Le Mahieu

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH
71 Upper North Street, Newtownards BT23 4JD
CHURCH OF OUR LADY OF THE VISITATION
Killinchy Street Comber BT23 5AP

Email: newtownards@downandconnor.org
Parish website:
www.newtownardsandcomberparish.com
Facebook: Parish of Newtownards & Comber
ST PATRICK'S PARISH HALL
Brian McDonald 028 91815051 for all enquiries

SACRAMENT OF CONFESSION

You are most welcome to come along to celebrate the Sacrament of Confession at the following times:

Tuesday 7pm+ in Comber
Friday 9am+ in St Patrick's
Saturday 5.45pm+ in St Patrick's

PRAYING OF THE HOLY ROSARY

Saturday 6-6.15pm in St Patrick's
Sunday 9.30-9.45am in Comber
Tuesday 7pm in Comber
Mass will be preceded by 15 minutes silence.

MASSES DURING THIS WEEK

MONDAY
No Mass
TUESDAY
Comber 7.30pm
WEDNESDAY
Newtownards 9.30am
THURSDAY
Newtownards 9.30am
FRIDAY
Newtownards 9.30am
SATURDAY
Vigil Mass Newtownards 6.30pm
SUNDAY
Comber 10am, Newtownards 11.30am

DIVINE OFFICE

Morning Prayer of the Church is celebrated in St. Patrick's Church on Wednesday, Thursday and Friday morning at 9.10am.
All welcome!

OUR LADY OF PERPETUAL HELP

The Tuesday evening Mass in the Church of Our Lady of the Visitation, Comber is offered as a novena Mass in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help. All welcome!

CELEBRATION OF BAPTISM & MARRIAGE

For enquiries, contact the Parish Office on 02891812137

CHILDREN'S LITURGY OF THE WORD

-every Sunday during the 11.30am Mass in St Patrick's
Children aged 6-11yrs welcome.

PARTICIPATION IN THE HOLY MASS-- Scripture Verses.

For those who would like to prepare for Mass in advance:

This Sunday-28th Sunday in Ordinary Time-Year A
First Reading Isaiah 25:6-10
Psalm 23
Second Reading Philippians 4:12-20
Gospel Matthew 22:1-14

Next Sunday 29th Sunday in Ordinary Time -Year A(Mission Sunday)
First Reading Isaiah 45:1, 4-6
Psalm 95
Second Reading 1 Thessalonians 1:1-5
Gospel Matthew 22:15-21

CONTINUOUS PRAYER FOR MARRIAGE & FAMILY LIFE

During this month of October we are asked to pray for MERCY and FORGIVENESS in marriage and in family life.

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTIONS FOR THIS MONTH

Pope Leo invites us to pray with him during the month of October, for mental health ministry:
-Let us pray that the mental health ministry be established throughout the Church, helping to overcome the stigma and discrimination of persons with mental illnesses.

OCTOBER-MONTH OF PRAYER FOR THE MISSIONS

During the month of October each year we are asked to consider the needs of the Church on the mission fields. Later in the month (18th October,) we will celebrate World Mission Sunday. Why not consider praying the daily rosary with family, or with friends, for the missions during this month!

Next Sunday, the Holy Father invites all Catholics to support *Missio* – his charity for world mission – through a special collection. This day of prayer, solidarity and giving unites Catholics worldwide to share the Good News of God's love which has the power to transform lives and heal our world. To donate, use the Missio envelopes, call 00353 1 497 2035 (office hours) or visit www.wmi.ie to give a gift, set up a Direct Debit and Gift Aid your donation if possible.

PRAYING FOR THE FAITHFUL DEPARTED

Months Mind: Patrick Donaghy

Anniversaries:

Bryce Haggan (1st,) May & George Hollinger, Mary & Jim O'Neill, Patrick McDonagh, Marie Carville, Danny Murray, Richard McKee, Kathleen McCabe, Maeve O'Hara, Angela O'Neill, Kathleen Megarry, Peter Eagleson, John Kennedy, Andrew McMullan.

OUR LADY'S ROSARY FESTIVAL

-will take place from 12th to 18th October 2026. Join us for a week of events to honour Our Blessed Lady, ending with the annual Belfast Rosary Procession. The procession will leave St Malachy's Church, Alfred St, Belfast at 2.30pm on Sunday 18th October, and finish at St Peter's Cathedral. A full list of events can be found on the poster at the back of the Church and online at belfastrosaryfestival.com

SAINT VINCENT DE PAUL

Sincere thanks to those who regularly donate to the SVP box at weekend Mass. Your generosity helps many needy individuals and families in these challenging times. In addition, donations of non-perishable items can be deposited in the designated containers in both churches. Donations will be passed on to the local foodbank for distribution.

SUPPORTING THE WORK OF THE CHURCH

This weekend there are two collections: the ***Weekly Offering*** in support of the parish and the ***Parish Maintenance Collection.***

Thanks to those who contributed so generously to the collections of last weekend. The Weekly Offering came to £1706 and the Monthly Offering came to £1290.

NEWTOWNARDS & COMBER PARISH NON-STOP DRAW

Week 24 5th September 2026

£100 no.324	Alicia Edgar
£50 no.357	Sylvia & Daye Rice
£50 no.355	Betty Carnduff

Congratulations to all the winners!

GIVING THANKS FOR THE HARVEST

At harvest time we give thanks to God for all the gifts we have been given. Next weekend 18th and the following (25th) October, we intend to decorate St Patrick's Church with some of the produce of the harvest. If you would like to donate some small items, fresh fruit or vegetables to decorate the church, feel free to do so. Bring the items along early to weekend Mass(or better still to weekday Mass,) and they can be placed into the baskets in front of the sanctuary. The donations will then be given to local charities.

FRIENDSHIP CLUB

The club meets in St Patrick's Parish Centre, Newtownards every Wednesday 2pm-4pm. Do come along to form and renew friendships. The club provides many opportunities for company, conversation and activities with many events organised throughout the year. Please spread the word-invite friends along too!

USEFUL NUMBERS

Saint Vincent de Paul Helpline	07738837984
Down & Connor Bereavement Support	07563195580
St Patrick's Funeral Catering Team	07769796997

SAINT PATRICK'S YOUTH CLUB

The club caters for the P3-P7 age group on Friday evenings during term-time. In order to comply with statutory and diocesan requirements, volunteers are required for the re-commencement of the Youth Club. As an adult, if you are interested, or to find out more, please provide your name and telephone number and kindly leave your details into the sacristy or the post-box at the parish office. Expressions of interest will be passed on to the youth club committee. Training and safeguarding training will organized for volunteers

IN SUPPORT OF HUMAN LIFE

During this week we are asked to pray for the protection of life: -

-this Friday is the feast day of St Gerard Majella, the patron saint of unborn children and expectant mothers. We pray for all who work in maternity units with pregnant women, that they may recognise that God is truly with us in each unborn child.

FORTHCOMING DATES FOR EUCHARISTIC ADORATION

Saint Patrick's Church 10am-4pm on the following Wednesdays:

21st October, 25th November, 16th December, 20th January, 17th February, 10th March, 14th April, 19th May, 17th June

TIDY-UP' SATURDAY- *Saturday 17th October 10am-12noon.*

Have you an hour or two to spare on Saturday 17th October?

We plan to host a *tidy-up* of the grounds around St Patrick's Church. As autumn sets in, and in advance of winter, you are invited to come along to help. Refreshments will be provided. We will meet at St Patrick's Minor Hall at 10am. Bring along your brushes, rakes, shovels, and gloves!

TAIZE HOLY HOUR

The monthly Taize Holy Hour before the Blessed Sacrament, including Taize chant, scripture reflection and opportunity for silent prayer will take place in Saint Comgall's Church this Wednesday October 14th at 7.30pm. In November the Holy Hour will take place in the Church of Our Lady of the Visitation, Comber.

PREPARATION FOR THE SACRAMENTS

Children in our parish schools continue to be prepared for the sacrament. For those who attend schools other than St Finian's and St Mary's, and who wish to be enrolled for the sacraments of First Confession, First Holy Communion and Confirmation, parents can contact the Parish Office newtownards&downandconnor.org

The deadline for enrolment is Saturday 31st October.

CARE OF SAINT PATRICK'S CHURCH

Volunteers are required to help care for St Patrick's Church, in terms of regular cleaning. We have four cleaning teams at present, providing an effective service on a Friday morning after Mass. Parishioners and visitors often comment on how well-presented the church is, thanks to all involved. At the time, some of the teams require additional volunteers. Would you be interested? If so, please leave your name and contact details into the sacristy; after-all, 'many hands make light work!'

ABIDE IN HIS LOVE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE

November 20-22nd in Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran.

Speakers include: Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans, Kimberlee Wooling, Fr Barry Braum and Bishop Fintan Gavin (Cork & Ross.) Book on Eventbrite:- tickets 70 Euro, 50 Euro for students.

COELIAC INTOLERANCE

For those with a gluten intolerance, special hosts are available in both churches. The special hosts enable those with the intolerance to receive the Holy Eucharist. Please speak to the sacristans before Mass if you wish to be included.

MASS RESPONSE CARDS

Mass response pamphlets are available in both churches for those who wish to use them. The cards can be helpful in aiding participation, particularly for the more complicated prayers of the Mass. Just speak to the members of the welcome team and they will be happy to help.

CELEBRATION OF THE SACRAMENT OF THE SICK

In anticipation of the Feast of Saint Luke, the Physician which takes place on 18th October, the Sacrament of the Sick will be celebrated during the 9.30am Mass on Friday 16th October in Saint Patrick's Church. Please spread the word! You may also consider providing transport to those who may like to receive the sacrament.

WORLD MISSIONS SUNDAY-18th October

Pope Leo XIV has recorded a special video message for the celebration of World Mission Sunday which can be accessed at VaticanNews.va

Missio, the Holy Father's charity for world mission and tasked with coordinating World Mission Sunday, is appealing for prayers and donations to support missionaries who serve communities in need, often in some of the poorest and most challenging places on earth. This year's theme, chosen by Pope Leo, is 'One in Christ, united in mission.' Being 'one in Christ' calls us to keep Our Lord at the centre of our lives and communities, and our mission is lived by witnessing to God's love through our words and deeds. In his message for World Mission Sunday, Pope Leo XIV shared:

'*Your prayers and practical support, particularly on World Mission Sunday, will be a great help in bringing the Gospel of God's love to everyone, especially the poorest and those most in need. Every gift, no matter how small, becomes a meaningful act of missionary communion.'* This year's celebration encourages every Catholic in the world to bring to life the mission given to them through baptism – to share the love of God with everyone, everywhere – by supporting missionaries who live alongside and serve communities in greatest need, wherever they are. Missionaries' work is rooted in peace, dignity and hope, and offers help to everyone, regardless of their background or belief.

Our Lady Queen of Peace KILWEE

VISIT OUR PARISH WEBSITE
www.ourladyqueenofpeacekilwee.com

Parish Office Contact Numbers and Email Addresses

Christ the Redeemer	02890309011	christtheredeemer@downandconnor.org
Derriaghy	028 92660073	derriaghy@downandconnor.org
Nativity	028 90625739	nativity@downandconnor.org
OLQP	028 90616300	ourladyqueenofpeace@downandconnor.org
St Luke's	028 90625739	stlukes@downandconnor.org
St Anne's	02890610112	stannes@downandconnor.org

Pope Leo's prayer intentions for October: **For mental health ministry.**
Let us pray that mental health ministry be established throughout the Church, helping to overcome the stigma and discrimination of persons with mental illnesses.

CONFESSIONS

As from the 12th October Confessions will be available every Saturday after the 10am mass.

Saturday morning mass in OLQP at 10.00am & Vigil mass in Christ the Redeemer @ 5pm



OCTOBER IS THE MONTH OF THE HOLY ROSARY
through meditation on His life, death, and resurrection. Catholics ask Mary to pray for us, not because she is worshipped, but because she is the Mother of Jesus and is believed to intercede for us.

Praying the Rosary can bring peace and help us slow down, especially during busy or difficult days. It gives us a way to place our worries and intentions before God, strengthens our faith and perseverance, and encourages virtues such as patience, compassion, humility, forgiveness, and hope.

The repeated prayers provide a simple rhythm that helps us focus on God and reflect on the Gospel. Even when we are distracted or don't know what to say, the Rosary gives us a way to continue praying and entrusting our lives to God.

Ultimately, the Rosary is not about simply repeating words, it is about spending time with God, contemplating Jesus, and allowing prayer to gradually transform our daily lives

OCTOBER AND WORLD MISSION SUNDAY is a time for the faithful of the world to show their appreciation towards the work of overseas missionaries. Please call Missio Ireland on (01) 497 2035 or go to www.missio.ie for further information

RISE AND SHINE GROUP would like to thank the parishioners for their generous contribution of £788 at the Church Door Collection

TO MAKE A DONATION TO THE PARISH PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE
ourladyqueenofpeacekilwee.com DONATE BUTTON
If you require a box of envelopes, please contact the Parish Office 90616300



The Sacrament of Baptism in Our Lady Queen of Peace will be on the **second Saturday of each month at 2.30pm.**
All parents are required to attend a Pre Baptism meeting which is held on the third Tuesday of each month at 7pm in St Colman's.

SICK AND HOUSEBOUND
If there is anyone in the parish who is sick and housebound and would like a priest to visit, please contact the parish office or email kilweeparish@gmail.com



ANNIVERSARIES **Mary O'Kane**
We pray for those whose anniversaries occur around this time
Eternal rest grant unto them O Lord and may perpetual light shine upon them

DAY PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK on Monday 2nd November for feast of All Souls, leaving St Agnes at 7.30am. Price £30 (includes tea and scone). Contact Pat 07946917354 or Harriet 07812098991



DIVINE MERCY DEVOTIONS with Adoration & Confession 7-8pm

Christ the Redeemer	Thursday 15th October 2026	
Nativity	Thursday 29th October 2026	Everyone Welcome

PIPS SUICIDE PREVENTION IRELAND
Weekend Crisis Hopeline, a regional overnight telephone service available Friday and Sunday nights, to anyone across Northern Ireland experiencing emotional distress, suicidal thoughts, or a mental health crisis.
The operational hours for the Weekend Crisis Hopeline are as follows.
Friday: 9pm - 10am Saturday
Sunday: 9pm - 9am Monday
028 9080 5850 | Freephone 0800 088 6042
We know that crisis doesn't wait for working hours. The Weekend Crisis Hopeline provides a confidential, non-judgemental space to talk with a trained crisis practitioner when someone is in distress, needs support or simply wants someone to talk to during a difficult time outside of usual working hours. There is no referral process for the Hopeline, and individuals can contact us directly whenever they feel in need of support.
For more information, please feel free to refer to our website where the information on the Weekend Crisis Hopeline is posted:
Weekend Crisis Hopeline - PIPS Suicide Prevention Ireland
If someone is in immediate danger or there is an emergency, call **999** immediately or attend your nearest Accident & Emergency (A&E) Department.

EUCHARISTIC HEALING & BLESSING SERVICE in St Matthews Church on Thursday 22nd October at 7pm

St. Anne's Parish

Fr. Martin O'Hagan, PP
Rev Pat McNeill, Deacon
Sr. Mary Murray, Parish Sister

***Parish Office**: 02890610112* ***Parish Centre**: 07762909559*
***www.*saintannesparish.net** ***Email**:* **stannes@downandconnor.org**

Twenty-Eight Sunday in Ordinary Time
Prisoners' Sunday



Mass this Week

St Anne's

***Saturday* 5pm Vigil** *(Confessions 4.30pm)*
***Sunday* 11.00 am**
Monday, Wednesday & Thursday 10.00 am

Our Lady's Rosary Festival Committee will speak after each mass.

St Colman's Sunday 12.00 noon
Tuesday 10.00 am

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament this week:
St Anne's Monday after 10.00 am Mass
St Colman's Friday 10.30am to 6pm

Preparation for Sacraments 2027

Does your child attend a non-Catholic school? Do you wish your child to celebrate one of their Sacraments next year?

If you have a child who attends a non-Catholic school and you wish them to celebrate a sacrament next year, school year Sept 2026 to June 2027, please forward full details to St Anne's Parish Office **before Saturday 31st October.**

Parish Office: open Monday to Thursday 9am to 1pm
Tel: 028 9061 0112 – Email: saintannes@downandconnor.org.

YOUR GIVING: **This Weekend 10th & 11th October**
Weekly Offering

Weekend 3rd & 4th October: –
Weekly Offering-Envelopes £822.40 Loose £560.50
Monthly Offering for Priests £1002.76

Set up a **Standing Order**. **Contact the Parish Office for forms or download the forms from our website:**
www.saintannesparish.net. **...or Donate Online**
to St. Anne's Parish - **A/C No. 07707787 Sort Code 93 83 00**

We Remember:

Recently Deceased:
Fr. Aidan O'Kane CP, Dympna Marshall, Vera (Madeline) Whelehan, Patricia Mooney

Month's Mind: **Daniel Shanks**

Anniversary: **Liam McEvoy, Molly & Colum McEvoy, Rita O'Neill**



Divine Mercy Devotions with Adoration & Confession 7-8pm

Christ the Redeemer Church
Thursday 15th October 2026

Church of the Nativity
Thursday 29th October 2026

Everyone Welcome

RECHARGE

St Colmcille's Church, Belfast

Tuesday 20th October
at 7.30pm Group Study

''Aquinas Diocesan Grammar School presents 'The Wizard of Oz' in the Assembly Hall on Wednesday 14, Thursday 15 and Friday 16 October at 7.00pm, to be seated for 6.45pm. Tickets are available on the school website.''

Conquest or Leaven: Reflections of a Catholic Priest in Palestine/Israel by **Fr David Neuhaus SJ**.
A special hybrid book launch at The **Belfast Jesuit Centre** on **Monday 19 October at 7.00pm**. Join us for a short talk from the author, a guided conversation, and live Q&A with Fr Neuhaus who will join us via live video link. His story - from South African Jewish roots to Christian faith and Jesuit ministry in the Holy Land - offers a powerful and unique perspective on justice, peace, and human dignity. Books will be available at a discounted rate.

Get to Know Your Parish

Thank you to all who contributed to making last weekend such a success – Those from the groups who manned the Group Displays – Those who provided the tea, coffee, and wonderful bakes and the ice-cream – Those who prepared the prizes for the Ballot and sold the tickets. All who made it a true experience of Parish.
Funds Raised – Ballot and Plant Sales £529.50 -Sincere thanks to all who supported the Ballot and congratulations to all the prize winners.

The Sanctuary Singers - £5156 raised at the concert for the two cancer charities. Huge thanks to Fr Martin, everyone who helped out in the parish. It was a very enjoyable and successful evening!
Thanks again, Loreto

Anniversary Mass Bookings

Because of the reduced number of Priests in our Family of Parishes and fewer masses being celebrated it has become necessary to change how Anniversary Masses are booked. To ensure smooth continuation of Mass Requests please call, in person, to the Parish Office with full details and stipend. Telephone and email requests will no longer be accepted.

Parish Office: Monday to Thursday 9am to 1pm
Tel: 028 9061 0112 – Email: saintannes@downandconnor.org.

Parish WhatsApp Group –keep up to date with what is happening in our parish community. Text your full name and number to **07565012056** to be added.

What is university actually for?
Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy is delighted to welcome **Dr Paul Shrimpton**, writer, historian and scholar of St John Henry Newman, for a public lecture exploring Newman's vision of **human flourishing at university** — and what it might still have to say to universities and society today.
Monday 12 October, 7.00pm
Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy, 30–38 Elmwood Avenue, Belfast
Students, staff, alumni and friends are warmly welcome. Admission free.

PAUSE FOR HOPE

Bringing together in prayer those who have cancer, have had cancer, their loved ones, and those who care for them.

🗓️ **Sunday 25 October**
🕒 **3.30 pm**
📍 **Clonard Church**

Come together for an afternoon of prayer, reflection and support.

❤️ **Reflect** | 🤝 **Connect** | 🌱 **Renew** | ✨ **Hope**

Together in Hope
Stronger Together

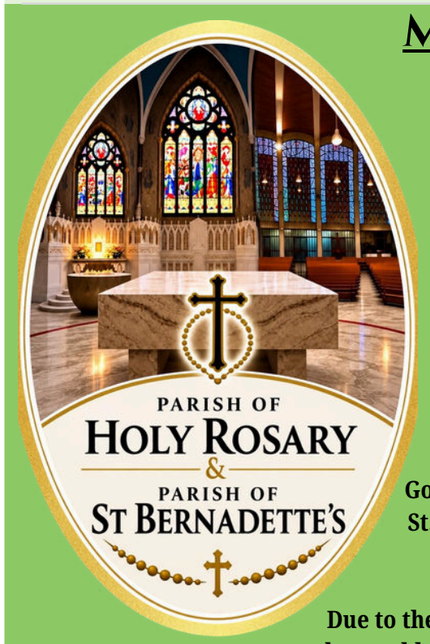
Save the date!

All are invited to come and hear from representatives of 6 Christian Churches who will consider: **'Who is Mary in God's Plan of Salvation?'** Martina Purdy will present on behalf of the Roman Catholic tradition. There also will be time for audience questions, chaired by Alf McCreary (*Belfast Telegraph, BBC News)*
This is an opportunity to listen and understand other perspectives.
Wednesday, 2 December 2026 at 7pm in Corr's Corner Hotel, Newtownabbey.
Refreshments will be served. To aid in planning please rsvp to ecumenical@downandconnor.org or via qr code on website

DIOCESAN NOTICE Leaflets are available on the parish website: www.saintannesparish.net

- Our Lady's Rosary festival
- What is University Actually For? Queen's Chaplaincy
- Eucharistic healing & Blessing Service – St Matthews
- Pause for Hope – Clonard Monastery





MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

St Bernadette's Parish
Vigil 6.00pm & 11am
Holy Rosary Parish
9am, 10.30am & 12.30pm

WEEKDAYS

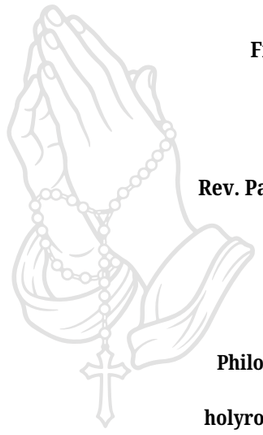
St Bernadette's Parish:
Mon, Tues & Wed 9.30am
Holy Rosary Parish:
Thurs, Fri & Sat 10.00am

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION
Good Shepherd church Saturday **10.30am**
St. Bernadette's church Saturday **5.15pm**

BAPTISMS
(Prior booking via Parish Office)
Due to the number of famililes requesting Baptisms we have added extra Baptism dates to our parish calendar!

Good Shepherd Church: At 2p.m on the 1st and 3rd Sunday of the month.
St Bernadette's Church: At 2p.m on the 1st Saturday of the month

CONTACT INFORMATION



Fr. Brendan Hickland, (028) 90642446 (Option 1)
b.hickland@downandconnor.org

Fr. Babu Panattuparambil Vareed (028) 9079 3023.
b.panattuparambil@downandconnor.org

Fr.Eddie O'Donnell (028) 90793023
e.odonnell@downandconnor.org

Rev. Patrick Keown (Deacon) p.keown@downandconnor.org

Kylee (Parish Support Officer) Office Hours
Mon-Thurs 9.15a.m - 1p.m. Closed Fridays

Holy Rosary Parish Office (028) 90642446 Option 2
holyrosary@downandconnor.org
Philomena (Finance Officer) p.dawson@downandconnor.org
More Information and resources:
holyrosaryparishbelfast.net and www.st.bernadettesparish.org

ABIDE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE

ABIDE in His Love WOMEN'S CONFERENCE

November 20-22, The Great Northern Hotel Bundoran, Co. Donegal. Speakers include: Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee Wooling, Danielle Noonan, Nashville. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin from Cork & Ross Diocese. For more details please visit Abide in His Love at eventbrite.ieRegistration link: https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com

Aquinas Diocesan Grammar School

Presents 'The Wizard of Oz' in the Assembly Hall on **Wednesday 14th, Thursday 15th and Friday 16th October at 7.00pm**, to be seated for 6.45pm. Tickets are available on the school website.
https://www.aquinasgrammar.com/News/Wizard-Of-Oz-Tickets/

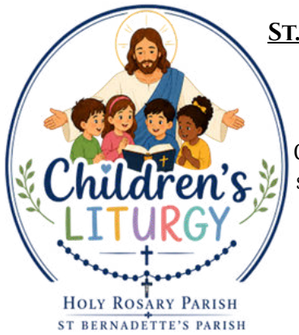


TWENTY- EIGHTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
SUNDAY
11TH OCTOBER
READINGS: A (I) ❖ PSALTER: WEEK 4



PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

ST. BERNADETTE'S CHILDREN'S LITURGY



All children of Primary School age are welcome. All new children must complete the Parents Consent forms which can be completed online by scanning our QR code or a paper copy which are available on our notice board at the back of the church. Looking forward to another fun year together. Any adults wishing to become a member of the children Liturgy please contact **Mary Grace Wilson on 07554386905.**

DATES FOR CHILDREN'S LITURGY:

Holy Rosary	18th October	1st/15th/29th November	13th December
St Bernadette's	11th/25th October	8th /22nd November	6th /20th December

? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ?
INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY
ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' Course

When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha.
FOLLOWING CHRIST is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The next session is **TUESDAY 13th October** at **7:00pm** in **HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.**

DCF 2026 - Dwell In Us

We are delighted to send you the QR Code to book this year's DCF weekend. (28th/29th November) Prices for this year are:
Day Seminar = £90 B&B = £65 (single)
or £60 per person (shared) B&B Friday night = £70 per person
U18 (can only attend day seminar) = £65

ST COLMCILLE'S BALLYHACKAMORE WOMEN'S DISCERNMENT NIGHT

Thursday 22nd October 7pm
RSVP TO DAVID: D.GOODWIN@DOWNANDCONNOR.ORG

Are you a young woman discerning God's call? Join us for an evevning of prayer, reflection, and fellowship with the Nashville Dominican Sisters as we explore God's call in our lives. Whether you're just beginning to ask the question or have been discerning for some time, all women throughout the Diocese aged 18-40 are welcome. Stay afterwards for refreshments and the chance to continue the conversation in a relaxed and friendly atmosphere. Our guest speaker is Sr Mary Sheila Maksim OP, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Limerick.

BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE

BJC Book Launch – Fr David Neuhaus SJ
Monday 19 October, 7.00pm
The Belfast Jesuit Centre invites you to the launch of Conquest or Leaven: Reflections of a Catholic Priest in Palestine/Israel.
Fr David Neuhaus SJ will join by video for a talk and Q&A. In-person event only.
Registration essential: **belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk**

WEEKLY COLLECTION:
Holy Rosary: £1809.00
St. Bernadette's: £1091.65

SUPPORT OF THE PRIESTS:
Holy Rosary: £1212.00
St. Bernadette's: £1031.79

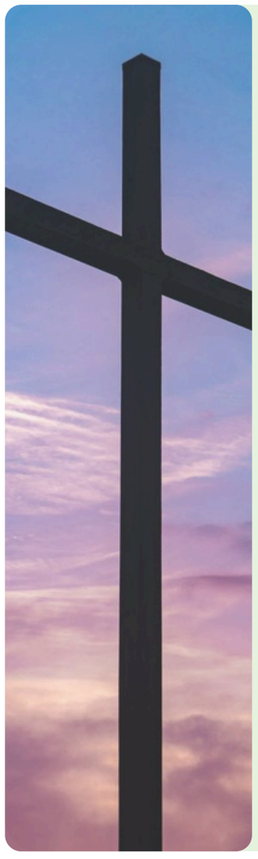
Many thanks for your continued generosity and support

The Building Fund will be taken up this weekend after Communion.
World Mission Sunday will be taken up next weekend.
Offering can be made by standing order or the Dona machines in the church porch.
If you wish to contribute to the parish regularly and wish to receive a box of Offertory envelopes or standing order form, please contact the Holy Rosary parish office and leave your name and contact details with Kylee and Philomena will contact you or you can email Philomena directly stating which parish you wish to contribute to.
p.dawson@downandconnor.org

Your St Bernadette's Parish Centre
for all bookings and enquiries please email:
stbernadettes@downandconnor.org

St Bernadette's Retirement Group
We hope to see you at our next coffee morning on **Wednesday 21st October** after Mass. New members are always welcome. £5 registration.
Our Thursday weekly walk: we meet at 10:15 in the church carpark.
All members are very welcome to join in at any time.

B.I.N.G.O is back, we're hoping for a FULL HOUSE!
18th October & 15th November.



REST IN PEACE
RECENTLY DECEASED:

John Charles Howard (Jack)
Sister Rosarie Prendergast
Teresa Graham
Marie Mullan (Née Hynes)
Gerry McCoy
Deirdre Mullan
Mary (May) Burke
Yvonne Cowan
Daniel Carty
Fr. Michael McConville
Georgia Ann Nugent

ANNIVERSARIES:

Patricia & Edward Gogarty (6pm)
Martin Gilroy (9am)
Doctor Gerry McCoy (MM 10.30am)
Mary Mulholland (11am)
Eddie Galway (12.30pm)
Margaret Crawford, Eoin Byrne
Nora Keenan, Mary Boyle, Jim Anderson
Michael & Sarah Guinness
Sr Eucharia CP , William McGlinchey

ETERNAL REST GRANT UNTO THEM, O LORD

Sunday Message

TWENTY-EIGHTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

THE WORD

Year A • 11 October 2026 • Colour: Green • Psalter Week 4



A FEAST FOR EVERYONE

MT 22:1-14

In today's Gospel, Jesus says that the Kingdom of God is like a king who gives a great feast for his son's wedding. He has sent out the invitations, but those he invited to the feast aren't interested. They don't show up. They make excuses and avoid committing themselves.

The king is furious and tells his servants that those he invited have shown themselves unworthy of the banquet. Instead, the servants are to go out onto the roads and streets and invite absolutely everyone they can find. There is no need for personal invitations. Everyone is welcome. Before long, the wedding hall is full.

In the parable, the king represents God. The great feast is a traditional Jewish image of God's kingdom. We see this in today's first reading from Isaiah. Matthew is telling the story of God's involvement with God's people, and how this is played out in the life of Jesus.

Matthew knows the end of the story. He has seen how Jesus was rejected by the people of Israel, for whom he came, just as they had rejected the prophets before him. They have rejected God's invitation over and over again, and so the Good News is now preached to the Gentiles. God is opening the gates of the kingdom to everyone everywhere.

God is a gracious host who hopes that everyone will come to his feast. It doesn't matter who we are or where we come from. All that is asked of us is that we respond wholeheartedly to this invitation by doing our best to live in tune with the values of God's kingdom. ■

DO

Think of your attitude to the stranger, the newcomer, the one who is different. How welcoming are you?

SAY

"Lord, help me to live in such a way that I will be able to feast at your heavenly banquet forever. Amen."

PRAY

Pray for those who have rejected God's invitation to his wedding feast. Pray that you will respond more fully to God's invitation.

LEARN

This is Prisoners' Sunday. We pray for prisoners and their families. We remember especially prisoners of conscience and political prisoners, those brave people made to suffer for their beliefs and moral courage.

REFLECT

Several years ago, an American woman called Tamara Fowler was due to get married. Two hundred guests were invited. But then, a few weeks before the big day, Tamara decided to break off her engagement. Her parents were heartbroken. They had been looking forward to the wedding and had spent thousands of dollars planning a dinner reception at a top restaurant.

Her father thought about the situation, talked it over with his wife, and prayed about it one night before going to bed. The next morning, he later said, he knew what they had to do. They decided to go ahead with the wedding dinner as planned—but not with the original guest list. Instead, they invited a different group: 200 homeless men, women and children. The family contacted a local homeless charity. The woman who picked up the phone later said she was so shocked, she thought it was a prank call. The Fowlers explained what they wanted to do and that they especially wanted to help children.

And so, on the day the wedding was due to take place, buses brought dozens of needy people to one of Atlanta's top wedding venues. Children had space outside to play. Face painters and jugglers were hired to entertain them.

The children, it transpired, had to be shown how to eat hors' d'oeuvres, how to use the right cutlery. They weren't used to fine china. At evening's end, the caterer was amazed. For the first time, she said, at the end of a big wedding there were no leftovers. Every plate was clean. Those special guests were fed, but they received more than a great meal that day – they received love. They felt included. They hadn't been forgotten.

That meal was a foretaste of the kingdom of heaven, an image of the heavenly feast. Pope Francis often described the church as a big tent and not a small chapel that holds only a few. He repeatedly stressed the importance of welcome and inclusion. Inclusion reflects God's mercy, he said, and God's mercy embraces everyone. Christians must mirror God's mercy by opening our hearts to others without judging or excluding anyone based on status, race, ability, or background. Inclusion, he emphasised, must go beyond rhetoric and be reflected in daily life. It should create a "culture of social tenderness."

Days after his election, Pope Leo said the same: "We must be a church with open arms for everyone, open to all who need our presence, dialogue, love."

As they sat in that hotel eating great food off of fine china, those homeless people must have said to themselves, "I wish it could be like this all the time." Of course, it couldn't. But they had been given a glimpse of how things could be, of how things should be.

To be Christian is to welcome and include. It's the opposite of them and us. Our challenge is to live in such a way as to make God's presence real and tangible, by creating homes, families, communities, and parishes that are welcoming and loving, so that ours will be a church of which it can be said: "Here comes everybody." ■

Parish of St MARY'S *on the* HILL 16th Aug 2026

Churches: St Mary's on the Hill & St Bernard's

PRIESTS OF THE PARISH
Fr Pat Sheehan & Fr Aidan Kerr
PARISH OFFICE 028 90832979
Lorraine Carlin & Patricia Gillespie
Opens Mon – Friday 9am – 1pm
165 Antrim Road. BT36 7QR
e-mail: stmarysoth@downandconnor.org
website: www.stmarysonthehill.online

RECENTLY DECEASED
Liz Dearlove, Harmin Pk
Alicia Devine, Tobar Glen Crescent
Catherine Mooney, Moyola Manor
MONTH'S MIND
Raymond Hassan, Michael McCorry
ANNIVERSARIES
Patrick Hughes, Martin Brogan, Billy Moran, William McCotter, Angela McClelland, Jim Curran, Veroncia Mulholland, Sarah Convery, William Burns, Baby Michael McKee, May O'Toole, Charlotte Fletcher, Patrick O'Neill, Kathleen McAuley, Rita Smyth, Mary Horan, Mathai Mani.

MASS INTENTIONS THIS WEEK

Sat 15th	6.00pm	Billy Moran M/M Michael McCorry
Sun 16th	9.00am	Angela McClelland & Jim Curran
	11.00am	Martin Brogan M/Mind Raymond Hassan
Mon 17th	9.45am	William Burns
Tues 18th	9.45am	Mary Horan
Wed 19th	9.45am	Patrick Hughes
Thur 20th	9.45am	Veronica Mulholland
Fri 21st	9.45am	Baby Michael McKee
Sat 22nd	9.45am	William McCotter

We welcome
Alivia O'Neill
recently baptised in the parish.



NO Divine Mercy in JULY & AUGUST
Back to normal for September.
Baptisms on a Sunday will be at 12.30pm.

ST BERNARD'S SITE RE-OPENS

FEAST OF THE ASSUMPTION Mass on the 15TH August at **12.00 noon in St. Bernard's Church**

Sunday masses will resume in St Bernard's Church Saturday 15th August vigil 6pm, Sunday 16th August 9am & 11am and baptisms at 12.30pm. No 12.30pm mass as we are still in the Summer Schedule. **However, there will be only limited parking in the top carpark at St Bernard's**. While the tarmac will be finished the lining of the top carpark will not take place until Tuesday 19th August. Some of the top carpark will not be available for parking; **the area nearest the steps leading to the Church will NOT BE OPEN and the GREEN GATES WILL REMAIN CLOSED.** The rest of the top carpark is usable but will not be lined.

To help with parking we have permission to use the school carpark, on the right of the laneway leading to the church, until the lining in the top carpark is completed.

Weekday masses will remain in St Marys on the Hill Monday 17th & Tuesday 18th August and resume in St Bernard's on Wednesday 19th August 9.45am.

SUMMER SCHEDULE JULY & AUGUST

St Bernard's Vigil	**6.00pm**
St Bernard's	**9.00am**
~~St Mary's on the Hill~~	~~10.00am~~
St Bernard's	**11.00am**
~~St Bernard's~~	~~12.30pm~~

Sunday 11th October 2026

We pray for the happy repose of the souls of:

Recently deceased:

Ava Kane, John O'Hara, Peggy Flanagan

Anniversaries/Intentions:

Hugh, John, Jim and Mary Carr, Pat Hughes, Brendan McDonagh, Vincent Johnston, Susie Megahey, Jackie Harrison, John, Jean & Paddy Moran, Jean McAlea, Eileen Doherty

Parish Income Update

Weekly Income Sunday 04 October: £870.94

Monthly collection: £588.07

Make giving easier by setting up a direct debit in place of your envelopes? Give the office a call to arrange. The 2027 envelopes have been ordered. The box will consist of 15 months supply to take you to the end of March 2028.

The 7 Joys of Mary

A **4-week reflection** on seven joyful moments in the life of the **Blessed Virgin Mary** will begin on **Wednesday 14th October at 7.00pm** in **St Agnes' Church**

November Intentions

Please remember that during November, all weekday intentions are for the November Dead list and no single intentions will be taken. This means the weekend Masses will be busy so please try to get anniversary dates booked soon to avoid disappointment.

The annual November dead Mass will be held on Friday 13th November.
Families who lost a loved one in the last 12 months will receive a letter of invite to the Mass. All family members are welcome. **Thank you.**

St Oliver Plunkett Parish

27b Glenveagh Drive, Belfast,

BT11 9HX. T: 028 9061 8180

Fr. Tony McAleese

(Office hours 9am - 1pm Mon, Tues, Thurs & Fri)

E: stoliverplunkett@downandconnor.org
www.stoliverplunkettparish.ie
Webcam: stoliverplunkettparish.ie/live-mass

SUNDAY 11TH OCTOBER 2026

Black Mountain Family of Parishes

Our emergency phone 07549209775.
Only for those needing the last rites, or in the case of a death. Thank you.

Fr McCullagh `	St Agnes	028 90615 702
Fr Gabriel Lyons	St Teresa's	028 9061 2855
Fr Ciaran Feeney	St Michaels	028 9508 8030
Fr Brendan Mulhall	Holy Trinity	028 9059 0985
Fr Patrick Devlin	St Joseph's	028 9061 4567

Fr Colin Grant and Fr Joe McGuigan are both assisting in our family of parishes

Month Mind Mass

The months mind Mass is booked by the family of the deceased, and not by the office. Please email the office to book in advance.
stoliverplunkett@downandconnor.org
Thank you.

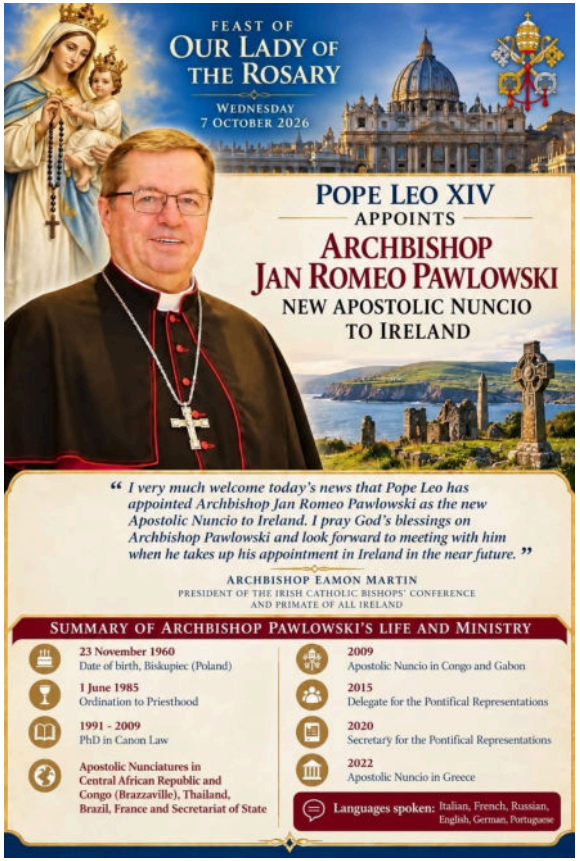
Our Lady's Rosary Festival 12th to 18th October 2026.

Join us for a week of events to honor Our Blessed Lady, ending with the annual Belfast Rosary Procession. The procession will leave St Malachy's Church, Belfast City Centre, at 2.30pm on Sunday 18th October, and finish at St Peter's Cathedral. A full list of events can be found on the poster at the back of the Church and online at belfastrosaryfestival.com

Parish Draw for October

1st Prize £150 - Carmel Burns
2nd Prize £50 - John Ross
3rd Prize £30 - Marie Thompson

Not long until we will be doing the £500 draw for Christmas! If you aren't in - you can't win. Join up for only £2 per ticket. Call the office to arrange.





So back to that time of year! We have sourced many great prizes this year for our Christmas Ballot. Tickets will again be £5 each and we should have them very soon. Please support if you can. **Thank You.**

Christmas Shoe boxes

Boxes are available from both porches. Please, only take the number of boxes you can realistically fill. Thank you in advance for supporting this project every year.

Lets make it the best year yet!!

St Oliver Plunkett Parish Mission
Monday 12th October - Sunday 18th October

Each day there will be prayer events planned to conclude with a Mission Mass at 7pm with an invited Guest Speaker. Our plan is to Celebrate Morning Prayer of the Church before the 10am Mass and after, to pray the Rosary. Each afternoon we will celebrate Adoration between 2-4pm with the first hour guided by NET. At 3pm in the parish hall a Prayer Session will be led by the NET team. At 6:30pm each night, before the 7pm mission mass we will celebrate Evening Prayer of the Church with a different speaker each evening.

Important notice!

The Mass on Sunday 18th October is not at 11am.

The Sunday Mass will be held at 3pm to close the Parish Mission.

Please come along - everyone is welcome.

Monday Morning Cuppa/Thursday Craft group

Due to the use of the parish hall for the parish Mission this week, these two regular events will be postponed (just for this week). Perhaps you could attend some of the events of the mission instead?

We would love to see you there. Everyone is welcome.

Day trip to Knock Monday 2nd November

For the Feast of all Souls - Leaving St Agnes' at 7.30am
£30 per person includes tea and scone
Contact Harriet 07812098991 or Pat 07946917354

BJC Hybrid Book Launch

The Belfast Jesuit Centre will host a live, hybrid launch of Conquest or Leaven: Reflections of a Catholic Priest in Palestine/Israel on **Monday 19 October at 7.00pm.**
Fr David Neuhaus SJ will join the BJC audience via video link for a talk, guided conversation, and live Q&A. His reflections on justice, peace, and human dignity in the Holy Land will be of interest to all parishioners, especially those involved in twinning or solidarity initiatives, peace-building or social justice. This is an in-person event and it is not possible to join online.

Books available at a 20% discount. Registration essential.
Please visit https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/hybrid-book-launch-conquest-or-leaven-by-david-neuhaus-sj/ to register.

PARISH OF ST TERESA OF ÁVILA

Web Page: www.stteresasparish.church
Email: stteresas@downandconnor.org

Black Mountain Family of Parishes

Fr Gabriel Lyons 028 9061 2855 g.lyons@downandconnor.org

Parish Office Open Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 9am to 3pm.

11 October 2026 Twenty Eighth Sunday of Ordinary Time, Year A . (Mission Month).

Sunday Gospel *The wedding garment is the desire of the heart to be a follower in name and deed. God invites all, but expects us to come with a good heart. Often we see people around mass who seem not to respect it. They may not come often, but God looks to the desires of the heart. Maybe the non-churchy parents who want their child baptised know deep down that their love for the child brings them to baptism. Is that not a good reason? Or maybe the young people who come to mass because they have exams coming up and need all the help they can get? While Jesus is totally the inviting one, he wants us to remain with him. The heart that follows is the heart that wants to love, and that desire is the wedding garment.*

Sacrament of Confirmation 15 April 2027, First Holy Communion 15 May 2027.

Sunday Masses Church of the Holy Spirit (Sat.) Vigil **5pm,** St Matthias' **10am,** St Teresa's **12noon.**

Weekday Masses St Teresa's, Tuesday **10am**, Wednesday **10am** (Mass of St Teresa), Thursday, Feast of St Teresa of Avila, Primary School Mass**10am**, all welcome. Friday**10am.**
St Matthias Monday **7pm**, Wednesday **9am,** Friday **7am** & Saturday **10am.**

Confessions Saturday **4 30pm** in Church of the Holy Spirit, after any Mass and on request.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament every Wednesday in St Matthias' Church from 11am to 4pm.

Please note, that in accordance with Bishop Alan McGuckian's recommendation, eulogies will not take place at Funeral Masses.

Nest Sunday a collection for World Missions will take place. If you would like to make a donation to the work of Missio Ireland there are envelopes available in the porch of the church which can be returned for next week.

To book an Anniversary Mass, Baptism or Wedding Ceremony please email the Parish Office.

Mass for all the Faithful Departed, especially those parishioners who died in the last 12 months.
St Teresa's Thursday 5 November 2026 at 7pm. All welcome.

Recently Deceased*:* John Walsh.

Anniversaries: John Captain, Mary McCloskey, Paul Dornan, Margaret Molloy, Hugh McPoland, Kathleen McIlroy, Gerald McIlroy, Marie Maguire, Roy Riddell, Eilish Smyth, Martin Kerr, Thomas Patterson.

Sanctuary Candles: Hugh McPoland, Margaret Molloy.